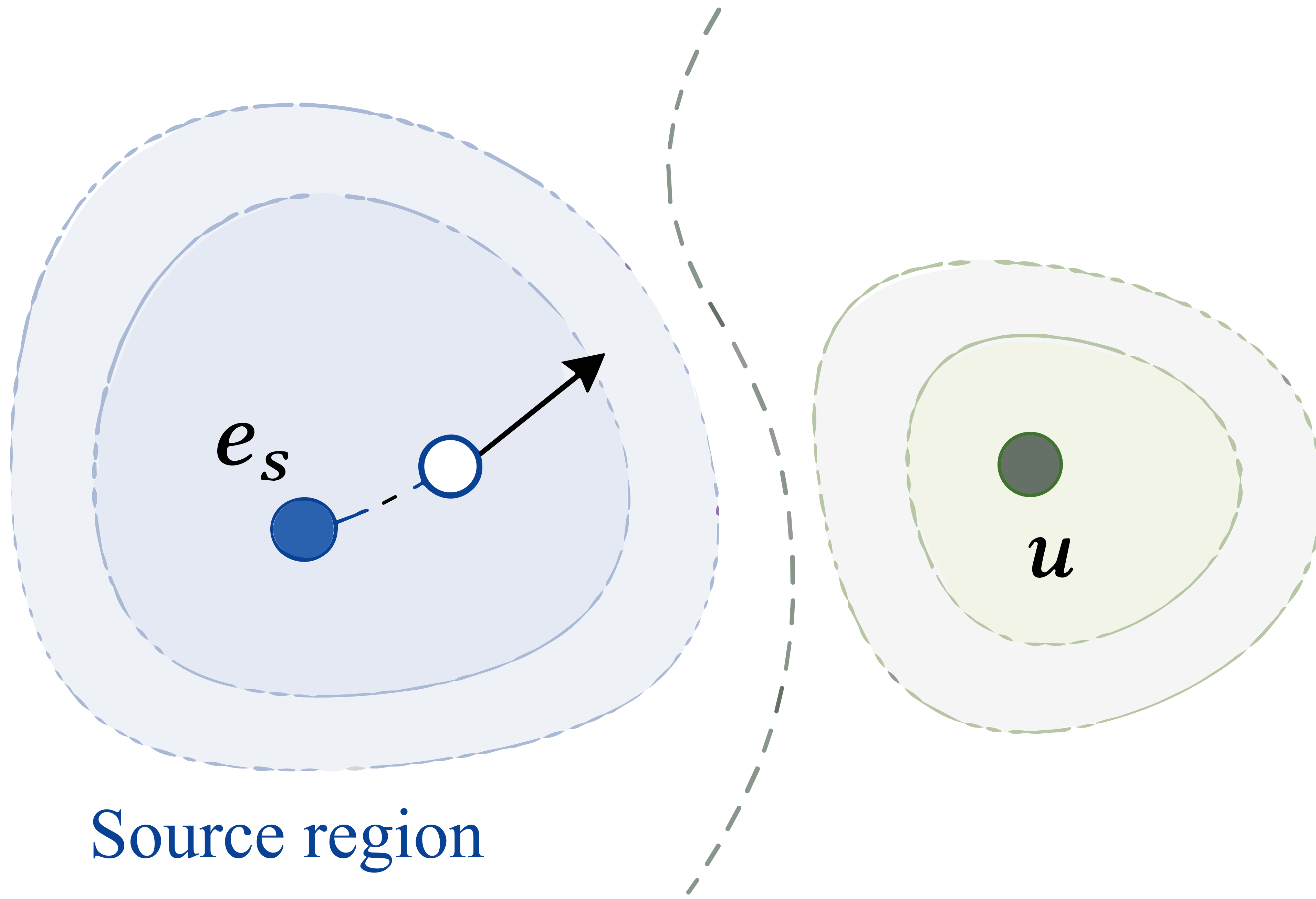


(a) Boundary Exit

Exit the source emotion region at the intermediate boundary layer.

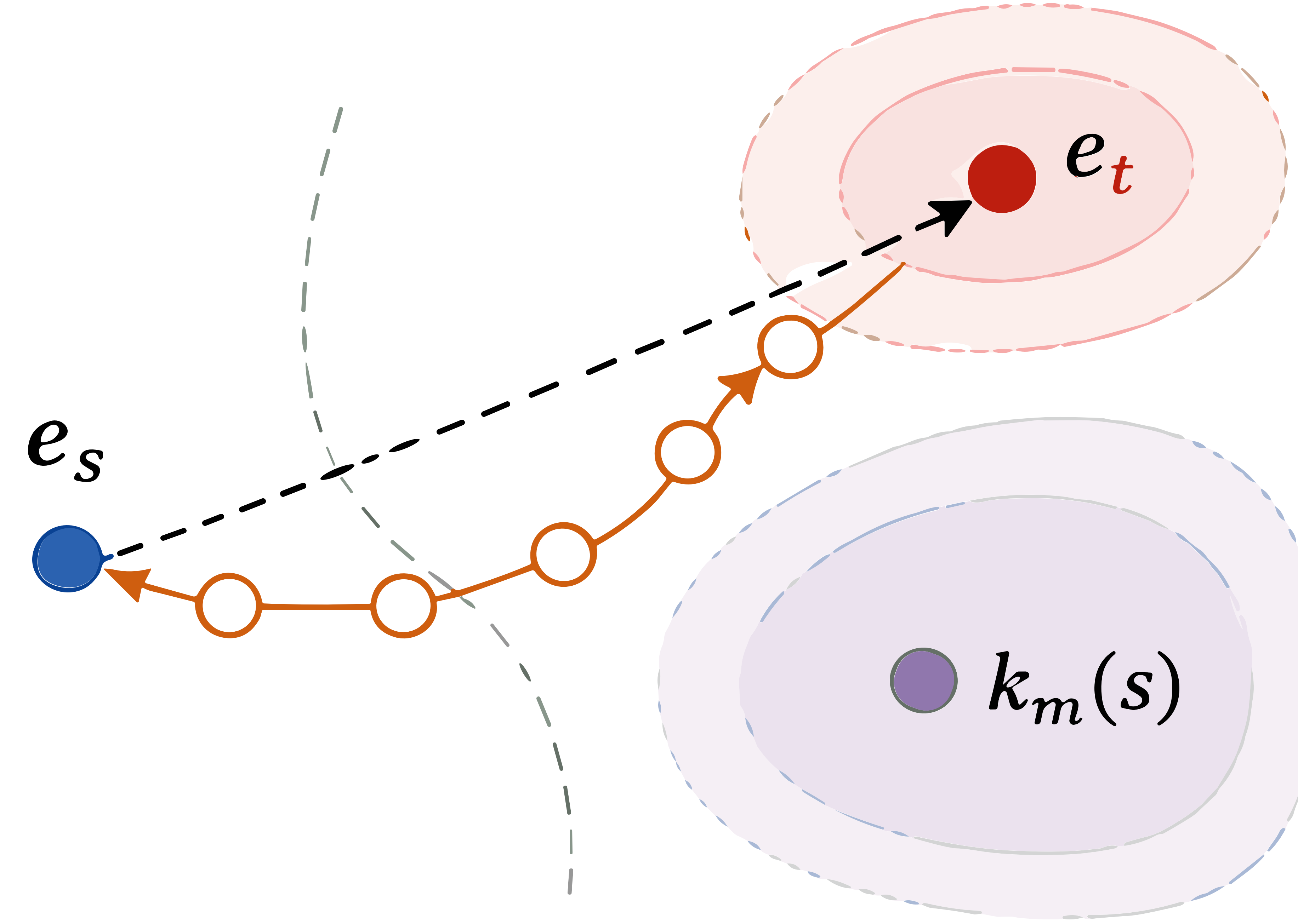


Objective: leave the source basin and approach the route.

Optimize: $\mathcal{L}_{exit}$

(b) Directional Steering

Steer along the target-consistent direction while avoiding the dominant competitor.

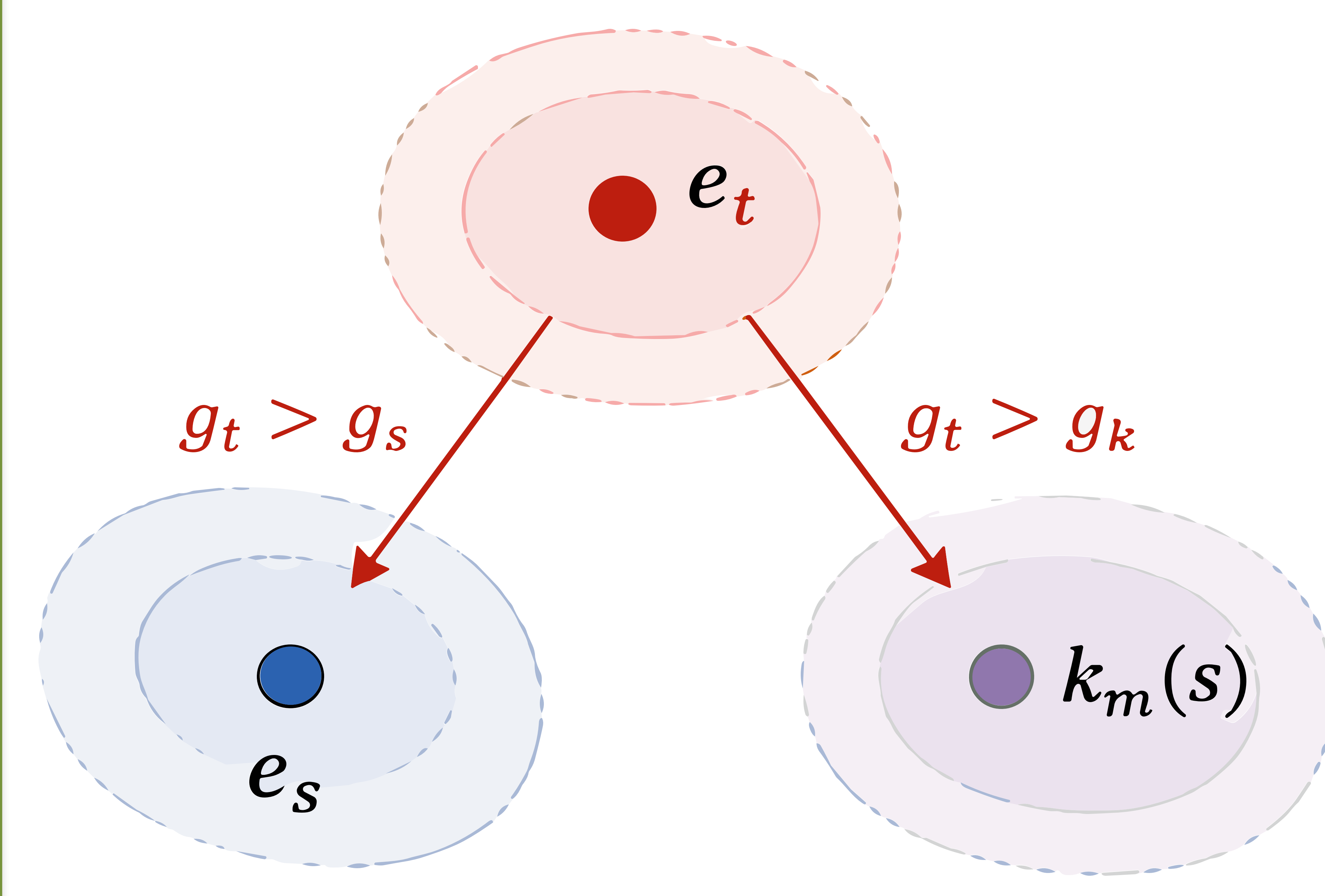


Objective: move toward e_t along the viable route and bypass $k_m(s)$.

Optimize: $\mathcal{L}_{steer}$

(c) Competition Consolidation

Reorder the competition so that the target dominates both source and competitor.



Objective: enlarge the target margin over both competitor and source.

Optimize: $\mathcal{L}_{steer}$

● e_s Source emotion ● e_t Target emotion ● $k_m(s)$ Dominant competitor ● u Next node on route ○ Current state - - Decision boundary - ➔ Target direction